BUILD YOUR AI CEO — THE COMPLETE SETUP GUIDE

Install Node.js and OpenClaw

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MODULE 4 — DOWNLOAD PACKET

Step-by-Step Installation Guide

Before You Start

You will complete two installations:

1. **Node.js** — the engine OpenClaw runs on
2. **OpenClaw** — your AI CEO's operating platform

Both installations take about 5 to 10 minutes total. Follow each step in order.

PART 1 — Install Node.js

Node.js is a software runtime that allows OpenClaw to run on your computer. Think of it as the engine your AI CEO needs to operate — the same way a car needs an engine before it can drive.

Step 1 — Open Your Browser

Open any web browser (Safari, Chrome, Firefox — any of them work).

Step 2 — Go to the Node.js Website

In your browser address bar, type:

```
nodejs.org
```

Press Enter.

Step 3 — Download the LTS Version

On the Node.js homepage you will see two download buttons.

Choose the one labeled LTS.

> *LTS stands for Long Term Support. It is the stable, reliable version recommended for most users. Do not choose the "Current" version.*

Click the **LTS** button to download the installer.

Step 4 — Run the Installer

On a Mac:

1. Find the downloaded file — it ends in `.pkg`
2. Double-click it to open the installer
3. Click **Continue**
4. Click **Agree** to accept the license
5. Click **Install**
6. Enter your Mac password if prompted
7. Click **Close** when the installation is complete

On Windows:

1. Find the downloaded file — it ends in `.msi`
2. Double-click it to open the installer
3. Click **Next** through each screen
4. Accept the default settings
5. Click **Install**
6. Click **Finish** when complete

Step 5 — Open Terminal

On a Mac:

Press **Command + Space** to open Spotlight Search.

Type `Terminal` and press Enter.

On Windows:

Press the **Windows key**, type `cmd`, and press Enter to open Command Prompt.

Step 6 — Verify the Installation

Copy the command below, paste it into your terminal, and press Enter:

```
node --version
```

✅ **What you should see:** A version number like `v20.x.x` or `v22.x.x`

If you see a version number, Node.js is installed correctly. Move on to Part 2.

> ***If you see an error instead:*** *Close Terminal, reopen it, and try the command again. If it still fails, restart your computer and try once more.*

PART 2 — Install OpenClaw

Now that Node.js is installed, you will install OpenClaw using a tool called **npm** (Node Package Manager). npm is like an app store for developer tools — it downloads and installs software with a single command.

Step 7 — Install OpenClaw

Copy the command below, paste it into your terminal, and press Enter:

```
npm install -g openclaw
```

> *The `-g` flag means "install globally" — OpenClaw will be available anywhere on your computer, not just in one folder.*

You will see a stream of text as npm downloads and installs OpenClaw. **This is normal.** Wait for it to finish. It usually takes 1 to 2 minutes depending on your internet speed.

When it is done, your terminal prompt will return to normal (you will see a blinking cursor again).

Step 8 — Verify OpenClaw Is Installed

Copy the command below, paste it into your terminal, and press Enter:

```
openclaw --version
```

✅ **What you should see:** A version number printed in the terminal

If you see a version number, OpenClaw is installed and ready.

Step 9 — Run the Setup Wizard

You are now ready to configure OpenClaw.

Copy the command below, paste it into your terminal, and press Enter:

```
openclaw onboard --classic --flow quickstart --install-daemon --skip-channels --skip-skills --skip-hooks --skip-search
```

This launches the OpenClaw Classic QuickStart wizard, which will walk you through the configuration one step at a time.

What this command does

It tells OpenClaw to:

- Open the Classic onboarding wizard
- Use the QuickStart setup path
- Install the managed gateway background service
- Skip messaging-channel configuration
- Skip optional skills
- Skip optional hooks
- Skip web-search configuration

Why we're skipping these items: We want to get your AI CEO's foundation installed first without adding unnecessary complexity. We'll connect Discord in Video 3. You can add other capabilities later.

What if you see a different screen?

OpenClaw changes over time, and some questions depend on your computer and installation history. The exact wording and order may differ.

- Follow the matching topic in your Cheat Sheet rather than relying on a specific menu number

- If a screen doesn't match anything described in the Cheat Sheet, pause and consult the troubleshooting section instead of guessing

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Step 10 — STOP! Open Your OpenClaw Terminal Setup Cheat Sheet

The Classic QuickStart wizard is now running.

Before answering the first question, open your **OpenClaw Terminal Setup Cheat Sheet**.

The cheat sheet explains the questions you may encounter, what to select, and which optional settings we're intentionally skipping.

Follow the guide until the installation is complete. Do not run the onboarding command a second time.

Quick Reference

Step	What You Do	Command or Action
1	Open your browser	—
2	Go to Node.js website	`nodejs.org`
3	Download LTS version	Click the LTS button
4	Run the installer	Follow the wizard
5	Open Terminal	Command + Space → Terminal
6	Verify Node.js	`node --version`
7	Install OpenClaw	`npm install -g openclaw`
8	Verify OpenClaw	`openclaw --version`
9	Run setup wizard	`openclaw onboard --install-daemon`
10	Open Cheat Sheet	Use it to answer every wizard question in order

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Troubleshooting

"command not found" after typing `node --version`

Node.js did not install correctly. Close Terminal, reopen it, and try typing the command again. If it still fails, restart your computer and try once more. If the problem continues, re-download the installer from nodejs.org and run it again.

"command not found" after typing `openclaw --version`

Close Terminal, reopen it, and try again. If the error continues, run the install command again:

```
npm install -g openclaw
```

npm shows a permission error on Mac

Type this command instead and press Enter:

```
sudo npm install -g openclaw
```

You will be asked for your Mac password. Type it and press Enter. (The characters will not appear as you type — that is normal.)

The installer download is taking a long time

This is normal on slower connections. Leave it running and wait for it to complete.

For additional help, visit the OpenClaw documentation at docs.openclaw.ai